The newer model isn't always the comparable one.

A 2021 Samsung 55-inch Q80A QLED needs a replacement. A quick search finds a newer "Neo QLED" at $699.99. Samsung's own specification sheet shows it falls short of the original in three ways. Item Assist compares replacements against the original's documented specifications, not against price position or branding.

ORIGINAL ITEM **Samsung QN55Q80AAFXZA** 2021 Q80A, 55-inch QLED · No longer sold new at Best Buy

DISPLAY	BACKLIGHT	NATIVE REFRESH RATE	4K@120HZ HDMI INPUT	VARIABLE REFRESH RATE
QLED with quantum dot color SAMSUNG	Direct Full Array SAMSUNG	120Hz (55-inch size) THIRD-PARTY: RTINGS Samsung's sheet does not state a native rate	One port (HDMI 4) SAMSUNG	Yes, all ports (FreeSync Premium Pro) SAMSUNG

SPECIFICATION	LOWER-PRICED CANDIDATE **Samsung QN55QN70H** **$699.99** Best Buy · Nov 9, 2026 · Black Friday Deal	SELECTED LKQ CANDIDATE **Samsung QN55QN80H** **$899.99** Best Buy · Nov 9, 2026 · Black Friday Deal	HIGHER-PRICED CANDIDATE **Samsung QN55S90H** **$1,199.99** Best Buy · Nov 9, 2026 · Holiday Deal
Display technology Original: QLED, quantum dot	✓ MEETS Quantum dot Mini LED LCD (Neo QLED)	✓ MEETS Quantum dot Mini LED LCD (Neo QLED)	▲ UPGRADE OLED, a different display technology
Backlight Original: Direct Full Array	✓ MEETS Mini LED backlight with Supreme Mini LED Dimming	✓ MEETS Quantum Mini LED, full array, with Supreme Mini LED Dimming	▲ UPGRADE No backlight; self-lit pixels
Native refresh rate Original: 120Hz, per RTINGS	✗ SHORTFALL 60Hz. Samsung also lists a 120Hz "DLG" mode that reduces image sharpness	✓ MEETS 144Hz (Samsung: VRR support)	▲ UPGRADE 165Hz (Samsung: VRR support)
4K@120Hz HDMI input Original: one port	✗ SHORTFALL None. Maximum 4K@60Hz, on 3 HDMI ports	✓ MEETS All 4 HDMI ports, maximum input 4K@144Hz	▲ UPGRADE All 4 HDMI ports, maximum input 4K@165Hz
Variable refresh rate Original: yes	✗ SHORTFALL Not supported (Samsung lists VRR and FreeSync as N/A)	✓ MEETS Yes, AMD FreeSync Premium Pro	✓ MEETS Yes, AMD FreeSync Premium Pro
Samsung U.S. list price	$899.99	$1,299.99	$1,999.99
Conclusion	✗ SHORTFALL **Does not meet the original's documented specifications**	✓ MEETS **Meets every specification checked**	▲ UPGRADE **Exceeds the original; a different tier**

Why not the QN70H. It costs $200 less than the QN80H, but Samsung lists 60Hz, no VRR and a 4K@60Hz maximum.

Why the QN80H. It matches or exceeds the original on every specification checked. It is selected on those specifications, not because it is the middle price. It is not presented as the lowest-priced suitable Samsung; a 2025 QN80F at $827.95 is unresolved.

Evidence. Original specifications are Samsung's, except the 120Hz native rate, a third-party measurement by RTINGS.

Refrigerator: when the original is still sold new

Original: Samsung RF28R7201SR, 4-door, FlexZone drawer (3.8 cu ft), external water and ice dispenser. Still sold new at Best Buy for $1,899.99.

Look-alikes each change something. The newer, larger RF32CG5B30SR ($1,799.99) is a 3-door with no FlexZone. The Bespoke RF29BB8600QL ($2,199.99) has no external dispenser and a smaller FlexZone. Finding the identical model removed the substitution question.

Prices. Best Buy selling prices on November 9, 2026, during sale events (Black Friday and Holiday Deals). They are not regular prices and will change. List prices are Samsung's published U.S. launch prices. A research example, not a claim determination.

GE dryer: age research

GE's serial number letters repeat every 12 years, so the same two letters can mean a dryer built in 2008 or in 2020. GE's own manufacture window for the model leaves one reading. No serial number was available for this example, so no unit date and no single ACV is stated.

GE GFD65ESSNWW (original): manufactured December 2019 to August 2023, per GE's Owner Center.
GE GFD65ESSVWW (successor): September 2023 to present. 101 of GE's 108 published specification fields are identical; no functional difference was found. $899.00 at GE.com and Home Depot on Nov 9, 2026 (sale event; GE list price $1,249.00).

GE's date code. First letter is the month, second the year; GE's chart repeats each year letter every 12 years (GE's example: "GA" is April 2001 or April 2013). Inside this model's window only M (December 2019), R (2020), S (2021), T (2022) and V (January to August 2023) are possible.

What each possible year letter means (illustrative: 13-year straight line, replacement value $899.00)

YEAR LETTER	UNIT AGE ON NOV 9, 2026	DEPRECIATION	ILLUSTRATIVE ACV
M (December 2019)	6.9 years	about 53%	$419 to $425
R (2020)	5.9 to 6.9 years	45.0% to 52.7%	$425 to $494
S (2021)	4.9 to 5.9 years	37.4% to 45.0%	$494 to $563
T (2022)	3.9 to 4.9 years	29.7% to 37.3%	$563 to $632
V (January to August 2023)	3.2 to 3.9 years	24.6% to 29.7%	$632 to $678
Whole window, no serial	**3.2 to 6.9 years**	**24.6% to 53.4%**	**$419 to $678**

Why the interpretation matters. Read the letter R without the model window and it can mean 2008: an age of about 18 years, fully depreciated, $0 before any client floor. Read correctly, it means 2020: 5.9 to 6.9 years and $425 to $494. The model window, not the letter alone, makes the finding defensible.

How the research is done

Original first. The original item is identified and its specifications documented from manufacturer sources before any replacement is considered.

Evidence is labelled. Documented by the manufacturer, measured by a third party, observed at a retailer on a stated date, assumed for illustration, or not determined.

Prices are dated. Observed selling prices are shown with the retailer and date. Manufacturer list prices are shown separately, and retailer crossed-out prices are not treated as regular prices.

Limits are stated. Same-brand search, one date, sale-event pricing, and every unresolved alternative are disclosed.

ACV is transparent. Replacement value, age evidence, method, useful life (a general published guideline) and condition are all shown. Item Assist does not determine depreciation, final ACV, coverage or settlement.

Sources: Samsung specification sheets and U.S. launch pricing (news.samsung.com); Best Buy and Samsung.com product pages and Home Depot (observed November 9, 2026); RTINGS Q80A review; GE Appliances Owner Center, date-code chart and product pages; ENERGY STAR product finder; NAHB / Bank of America Home Equity, Study of Life Expectancy of Home Components (2007). Full list with links: itemassist.com/report

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